

Be my Shotgun, Sir! - Game Concept

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1 Constraints

- **Game Genre:** Sport/simulation: RACING (urban or competitive)
- **Time:** Present
- **Cards**
- **Mindset:** Casual
- **Bartle's type:** Socializer
- **Mode:** Multiplayer (4-8 players)



Fig. 1: Knights card

This card inspired a power-up that allows a team to obstruct other players on the track. The mechanic mimics a knight using his spear to fend off opponents

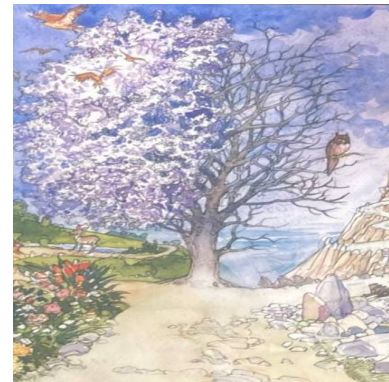


Fig. 2: Crossroads card

This card inspired the circuit-forking dynamic, allowing players to iteratively choose their route at key junctions.

2 Game Design - Part 1: concept

Concept

Be my Shotgun, Sir!

Logline

Drive together, fight together: Driver and Shotgun collaborate to fend off rivals and reach the finish line first.

Introduction

In a world where a Driver cannot exist without their Shotgun, racing is the ultimate proof of a perfect bond. Each competition is a relentless series of forks where synergy is everything: the Shotgun anticipates the route and the Driver executes, as the duo strives to break records while sabotaging rival teams. Winning intermediate championships is the only way to earn coin and secure permits for elite arenas, where the loot is greater but the opposition is fiercer. Only perfect synchrony allows the team to overcome enemy obstacles and cross the finish line first.

Description

The gameplay is built on an asymmetric coordination challenge where the duo must constantly manage the trade-off between information and speed. While the Driver maintains total physical control of the sidecar, the Shotgun navigates using a dynamic map that progressively reveals upcoming forks, obtainable power-ups, and daunting obstacles. This partial reveal serves as the game's strategic core: making an instinctive choice based on limited data grants an Early Commitment Boost (a speed surge inversely proportional to decision time) but increases the risk of entering a more treacherous path.

Throughout the circuit, the team collects power-ups that only the Shotgun can trigger. However, their impact is not static; the Driver's performance while a power-up is active directly dictates its effectiveness, determining whether it successfully boosts the team or effectively sabotages opponents. By winning races and strategically managing the pre-race betting system, players accumulate the resources necessary to customize their vehicle and secure the permits required to climb the championship ranks toward the most lucrative arenas.

Key features

- **Early Commitment Boost**

This mechanic rewards players for decisive action under uncertainty. The velocity increase triggered by a choice is inversely proportional to the time spent making it: the sooner the team commits to a path after the decision phase begins, the more powerful the speed boost will be. This creates a high-stakes tension where the Shotgun must balance the need for more "intel" with the necessity of a rapid "early commitment" to maintain a competitive edge.

- **Synergy-Driven Asymmetric Roles**

The game enforces a drastic separation of duties between the Driver and the Shotgun, making communication the ultimate survival tool. While the Driver manages the immediate physics of the vehicle and executes maneuvers, the Shotgun acts as a tactical navigator with exclusive access to future data. Neither player can succeed alone: the Driver is "blind" to the upcoming circuit's layout, and the Shotgun is powerless to act on the information they possess, requiring absolute synergy to win.

- **Proximity-Based Intel Reveal (The Shotgun's Map)**

The Shotgun holds the exclusive ability to view the map of the next phase following the upcoming fork. However, the visible portion of the track is incomplete: the revealed area expands progressively only as the vehicle approaches the current obstacle. This mechanic serves as the game's primary risk-reward engine: to secure the maximum Early Commitment Boost, the Shotgun must urge the Driver to make a choice while the map is still partially obscured, relying on intuition or limited data. Waiting for a clear view of the future guarantees a safer path but drastically penalizes the team's overall speed.

- **Risk-Reward Betting System**

Before the race begins, the duo can choose to wager a portion of their current resources on their own victory or specific performance goals. A successful bet significantly amplifies the final winnings, providing a shortcut to high-end sidecar customization and elite racing permits. However, failing to meet the wagered objective results in a loss of capital, forcing the team to carefully weigh their confidence in each race.

Platform(s)

- **Mobile:** the constraints force us to aim for casual players, for whom mobile is the ideal platform that naturally allows for that type of gameplay. Furthermore, since smartphones are ubiquitous, mobile serves as a highly attractive platform to lower the barrier to entry and simplify user acquisition.
- **PC:** since this is our primary development platform, early tests will be executed on laptops; therefore, we consider it an easy-to-add destination platform, although we do not guarantee its final availability.

Concept Art

The concept art was generated using AI as an exploratory tool to help define and refine the intended visual style and tonal direction of the game. Here are representative AI-generated concept images used to establish the project's visual tone.



Fig. 3: Concept Art
Gameplay with power ups and crossroads



Fig. 4: Concept Art
Driver and the Shotgun discussing the direction to be taken

Notes

The **Shotgun** term originates from the American Old West where the passenger sitting next to the driver carried a shotgun to defend the vehicle from bandits and hazards. In modern slang "calling shotgun" is the phrase used to claim right of the front passenger seat. ([Wikipedia](#))

3 Game Design - Part 2: formal and dramatic elements

Formal Elements

- Players**
 Team-based multiplayer where each team is a duo composed of one Driver (physical control) and one Shotgun (tactical navigation).
- Objectives**
 Be the first to cross the finish line, use power-ups to slow down rival teams, and win pre-race bets to customize your sidecar.
- Procedures**
 The duo approaches iterative binary forks where the Shotgun analyzes a fragmenting map to suggest a path. The Driver can choose to commit early to trigger a speed boost a maneuver know as "*Early Commitment*" or wait and rely on the Shotgun for more complete information. Power-ups are strategically collected and deployed to slow down the opposing sidecar and gain a competitive time advantage.

- **Rules**

- The Driver cannot race without a Shotgun.
- The "*Early Commitment*" boost is inversely proportional to decision time. The earlier the decision is made, the more stronger is the boost.
- Information on the Shotgun map is revealed gradually, and once a choice is made, no further data is provided for that section. This make the decision trade-off, a high-stakes balance between maximizing the "*Early Commitment*" boost and minimizing the risk of incomplete information.

- **Resources**

- Intel (partial map data)
- Power-ups (sabotage or boost tools)
- Coin required for sidecar customization and to gain access to more profitable races

- **Conflict**

Direct competition against rival teams, tactical sabotage using obstacles, and the psychological tension of making rapid decisions with incomplete information.

- **Boundaries**

The physical limits of the racing circuits as well as the "Strategic Fog" that restricts visibility on the Shotgun Map.

- **Outcomes**

Race victory, acquisition of new permits, and the financial resolution of bets after each race.

Dramatic Elements

- **Challenge**

The core difficulty lies in balancing the need for more information with the necessity of a rapid "*Early Commitment Boost*".

At the same time, the use of power-ups must be strategic and tightly coordinated between Driver and Shotgun, ensuring their deployment is deliberate and timed to maximize impact against opposing teams in order to slow them down.

- **Play**

A mix of high-adrenaline arcade racing and deep social cooperation, where players experience the thrill of "blind" trust and the satisfaction of perfect synchronization.

- **Premise**

The game is built around asymmetric cooperation between a Driver and a Shotgun, where success depends entirely on communication, timing, and shared decision-making. There is no narrative framing; the focus is on fast-paced, replayable races that highlight coordination and teamwork.

- **Character(s)**

The Driver (representing instinct and reflexes) and the Shotgun (representing vision and strategy).

- **Story**

Teams compete across a series of races designed to test their coordination and teamwork. As a casual experience, the focus is not on narrative progression but on fast, replayable matches where chemistry, communication, and smart decisions determine who takes the win.